

30 CHAPTERWISE IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

Social Science (087) | CBSE 2026-27

Federalism

Political Science | Board-examinable

30 original revision questions with answers: short-answer, competency, assertion-reason and long-answer practice. Set is based on the current syllabus and official question-paper style; it is not a prediction or an official CBSE paper.

Question 1

What makes a system federal rather than merely decentralised?

Answer:

A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. A central government cannot unilaterally remove those powers.

Question 2

How have language policy and state reorganisation strengthened Indian federalism?

Answer:

States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. India also avoided imposing one language as the only national language, helping accommodate diversity.

Question 3

What is the role of local self-government in a federation?

Answer:

Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents. Constitutional recognition and regular elections give local bodies a role in addressing local needs.

Question 4

What is the central idea or skill tested in Federalism?

Answer:

The central focus is: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. This is the starting point for a strong answer from this chapter.

Question 5

Write two relevant points for a short answer based on Federalism.

Answer:

First point: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. Second point: States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. Link the two points clearly instead of listing them without explanation.

Question 6

How does the first key idea in Federalism lead to an important result or conclusion?

Answer:

Begin with the key idea: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. Then connect it to the result: States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education.

Federalism - Continued

Question 7

What evidence, calculation, incident or concept best supports the first main idea in Federalism?

Answer:

Use this supporting detail: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. A central government cannot unilaterally remove those powers. The relevant detail should be stated before giving the final conclusion.

Question 8

Explain the importance of the second major idea in Federalism.

Answer:

States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. India also avoided imposing one language as the only national language, helping accommodate diversity. Its importance lies in showing how the chapter develops the topic beyond a simple fact or definition.

Question 9

What common mistake should a student avoid while answering a question from Federalism?

Answer:

Do not give only a conclusion. Explain the reasoning with a correct detail, such as: Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents.

Question 10

Compare the first and second important ideas in Federalism.

Answer:

The first idea is: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. The second idea is: States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. A complete comparison states both the difference and the connection between them.

Question 11

Show a cause-and-effect link from Federalism.

Answer:

Cause or starting point: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. Effect or outcome: States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. Use connecting words such as 'therefore', 'as a result', or 'thus'.

Question 12

What is the most useful sequence for explaining the main content of Federalism?

Answer:

A clear sequence is: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. Next, States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. Finally, Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents.

Federalism - Continued

Question 13

Give a 40-50 word answer outline for an important question from Federalism.

Answer:

Start with the direct answer: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. Add one supporting point: States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. End with the outcome or message: Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents.

Question 14

How should you support an answer from Federalism with a relevant example or fact?

Answer:

Use a precise example or explanation: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. State the fact, then explain its significance rather than leaving it as a name or date alone.

Question 15

How can an examiner see that you understand, rather than memorise, Federalism?

Answer:

Connect the idea to its reason or result. For instance: States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. Then explain why this point matters in the chapter's context.

Question 16

State one inference that can be drawn from the main situation or concept in Federalism.

Answer:

A sound inference is that panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents. This inference must be supported by a relevant point from the chapter.

Question 17

Frame a short competency-based response using the first two ideas in Federalism.

Answer:

Apply the concept by first stating: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. Then justify the response with: States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education.

Question 18

What would make an answer from Federalism incomplete?

Answer:

An answer is incomplete if it omits the explanation or final implication. Include both: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. Also add: Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents.

Federalism - Continued

Question 19

Prepare an Assertion-Reason style explanation based on Federalism.

Answer:

Assertion: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. Reason: States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. Check whether the reason actually explains the assertion before choosing an option.

Question 20

How should you justify an answer from Federalism in two clear steps?

Answer:

Step 1: state the concept or event - A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. Step 2: support it with the explanation or result - States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education.

Question 21

What answer structure is suitable for a 3-mark question from Federalism?

Answer:

Use three connected points: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents. Keep the points specific and write them in a logical order.

Question 22

What answer structure is suitable for a 5-mark question from Federalism?

Answer:

Give an introduction, develop these key points - A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. - and close with: Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents. Add a diagram, equation, example, or textual reference where relevant.

Question 23

How can the ideas in Federalism be applied to a new situation or case study?

Answer:

Identify the relevant principle first: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. Then use the chapter's reasoning to explain the case: States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education.

Federalism - Continued

Question 24

Which detail from Federalism is most likely to earn an extra mark when explained correctly?

Answer:

A useful detail is: Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents. Explain it in context instead of using it as an isolated statement.

Question 25

Write a brief concluding statement for an answer on Federalism.

Answer:

A suitable conclusion is: Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents. This conclusion should follow naturally from the explanation rather than introduce a new point.

Question 26

Make a three-point revision note for Federalism.

Answer:

1. A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. 2. States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. 3. Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents. Revise these points with the chapter's examples, terms, and practice questions.

Question 27

How would you self-check an answer from Federalism before submitting it?

Answer:

Check that you have answered the exact question, used the key idea - A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. - and supported it with a reason, example, calculation, or outcome such as: States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education.

Question 28

Why does Federalism remain important for revision?

Answer:

It combines factual recall with explanation and application. The main takeaways are: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents.

Question 29

Create a final 60-80 word answer plan for a long question from Federalism.

Answer:

Opening: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. Development: States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education. Conclusion: Panchayats and municipalities bring decision-making closer to residents. Use complete sentences and include all required evidence, steps, or references.

Federalism - Continued

Question 30

What is one last-minute revision question you should ask yourself about Federalism?

Answer:

Ask: 'Can I explain why this is true or important?' A correct self-answer should include: A federation has constitutionally divided powers between levels of government, and each level has authority in its own area. and States were reorganised largely along language lines, allowing people to use their language in administration and education.

Sources: CBSE Social Science curriculum 2026-27; CBSE Class X sample papers and marking schemes 2026-27; NCERT textbooks.

ONE SHOT MASTERY